```
  .attr("height", function(d) {return yScale(d.numTweets);})
  .attr("x", function(d,i) {return i * 60;})
  .attr("y", function(d) {return 100 - yScale(d.numTweets);})
  .style("fill", "blue")
  .style("stroke", "red")
  .style("stroke-width", "1px").style("opacity", .25);
}
```

2.3.2 Setting channels

So far, we've only used the height of a rectangle to correspond to a point of data, and in cases where you're dealing with one piece of quantitative data, that's all you need. That's why bar charts are so popular in spreadsheet applications. But most of the time you'll use multivariate data, such as census data for counties or medical data for patients.

"Multivariate" is another way of saying that each datapoint has multiple data characteristics. For instance, your medical history isn't a single score between 0 and 100. Instead, it consists of multiple measures that explain different aspects of your health. In cases with multivariate data like that, you need to develop techniques to represent multiple data points in the same shape. The technical term for how a shape visually expresses data is *channel*, and depending on the data you're working with, different channels are better suited to express data graphically.

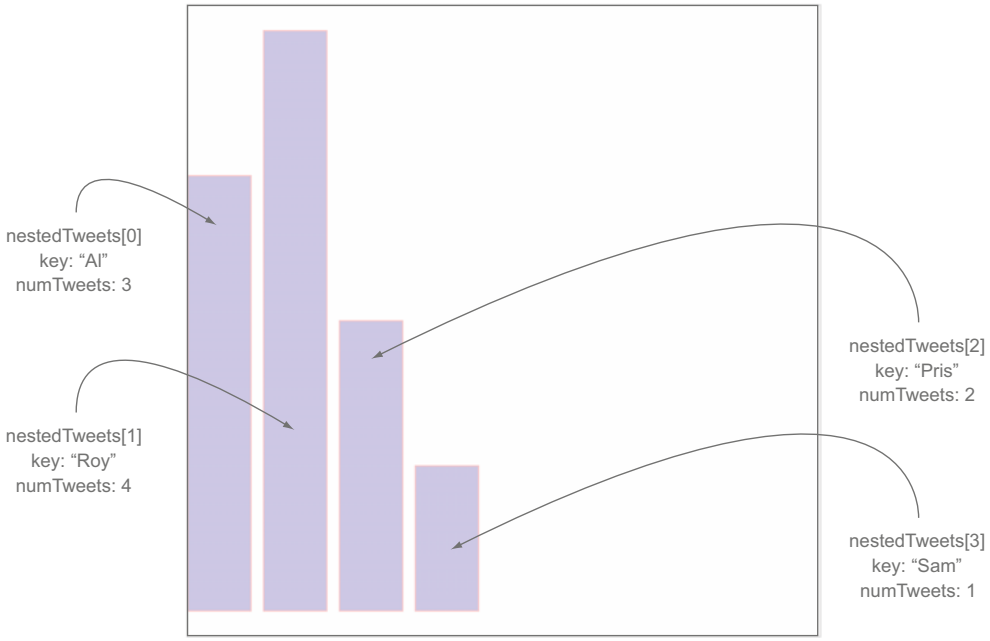


Figure 2.22 By nesting data and counting the objects that are nested, we can create a bar chart out of hierarchical data.